

One of a Kind

It takes an artist's eye



Overview

No photography allowed in this gallery. Or the hallway, or outside, or anywhere. And don't even think of making a photocopy of this document.

Focus

Destroy copycats; protect original work.

Domain

In the walls of a public creative hotspot in your Branch's region, such as a community graffiti wall, a stairwell where everyone draws on the walls, a gallery, or an art studio.

Appearance

A dizzying array of doodles and colors that travels in 2D space along walls, ceilings, and floors. The Anomaly may also present spider or peacock imagery.

Impulse

Mirrors cracking, printers breaking— anything that would create a copy of an image is prohibited by the Anomaly (screenshots, photos, reflections, etc). Copies made by a human hand (for example, a painstakingly realistic portrait drawn in charcoal) are exempt. People who have tried to take photos or otherwise make copies of original work have been trapped within nearby artwork and replaced with Impersonating Minor Anomalies that are zealously creating (mediocre) original work.

Situation

Several disturbingly vandalized pieces of art— someone has added the faces of students and staff members pressing their hands against the surface of the artwork, as if trying to escape it.

The people pictured have been trapped inside of the images, and were replaced by Impersonating Minor Anomalies, who are dismissive of the situation, and have turned their attention to a new artistic hobby.

Optional Objectives

- +1 Commendation for admiring the artwork
- +5 Commendations for doing something adventurous or daring
- +10 Commendations to the Agent with the most avant-garde work, determined at the end of the mission
- +1 Demerit for copying someone else

Points of Interest

A local arts center's photography classes have been cancelled, and all photography equipment has been disposed of. The instructor has been acting uncharacteristically, and recently began learning charcoal drawing despite a well-known disdain for powdery, messy mediums.

An office building's printer has exploded, and the resulting ink splatters spell out "UNORIGINAL". Every mirror in the building has cracked. Any dependency they may have had on generative AI has been replaced by human employees, and the company has taken an interest in blockchain and Non-Fungible Tokens.

Jun-Young Lee (he/they), is a fantasy illustrator whose work has been repeatedly stolen to train generative AI models. He encountered a Caricature of himself while attempting to take a photo of the hallway to use as art reference. They may be encountered near the Anomaly's Domain, planning out their new series of mythical creature illustrations.

Notable Chaos Effects

2	Caricature	An exaggerated illusory copy of the target manifests, and is perceptible only to the target.
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Expected Behavior

Demeanor

The Anomaly protects artists and their work overzealously. It presents itself as a patron of the arts, a defender of human creativity, and a muse for struggling artists. It may communicate through its Caricatures, synesthetic colors, and moves fluidly— like a stylized animation.

Operating Principle

This Anomaly is most fond of Imprisoning and Impersonating Minor Anomalies. Before trapping anyone, it issues a warning through a Caricature. The Anomaly creates its own "art" by trapping people in images, and appears to take pride in the compositions it has created. It is easily flattered by compliments on its work.

Confrontation

To lure the Anomaly from its hiding place, Agents may have to exhibit artwork or become involved with the local arts scene. The Anomaly may camouflage itself as a work of art in its Domain. This vain Anomaly could be satisfied by exhibiting its work to the public and ensuring that accredited critics give it top marks for originality or creativity.

Morning Meetings

- A Relationship passionately endorses NFTs to an Agent.
- A local arts building has been renovated. Its exterior now features extensive detailing, all done by hand.
- An Agent tries to print a document at work. The printer explodes.
- A Relationship's friend signs up for a photography course, and goes missing.

Projected Gains & Losses

If captured, the Anomaly's power could be used to create a Requisition that causes a piece of art to become overwhelmingly fascinating to mundane people, utilizes the Anomaly's Caricature ability, or traps objects within photographs.

Those who have been trapped in an image by the Anomaly will be particularly difficult Loose Ends to deal with. If allowed to escape, the Anomaly may flee into a piece of well-known artwork and attract artists. It will fervently defend their creative endeavors by trapping copycats.

I'm sure this Anomaly would react well to a use of your Best Self.